EUROPEAN YOUTH PARLIAMENT
PARLEMENT EUROPÉEN DES JEUNES

European Youth Parliament (EYP)
Parlement Européen des Jeunes (PEJ)

This document was adopted by GBIII

Governing Body (GB)

Guide to Writing a Resolution

The present document aims to give some guidelines for successful resolution writing at EYP International Sessions. The document can, however, also be used for other EYP sessions at the national/regional level.

I. The resolution

EYP produces its statements in the format of resolutions. The resolution is a formal statement of an opinion proposed by the delegates on how to deal with a given issue. Essentially, resolutions are the goal of committee work, and serve as a statement of resolve to progress in a specific matter outlined in the resolution.

The goal of the resolution is to inform and educate the reader in order to inspire them to take action approving the resolution.

To do this, a successful resolution must do two things:

- identify and explain the problem that needs to be addressed (the introductory clauses); and
- propose a solution that will address the problem as identified (the operative clauses).

A resolution has three parts: the heading, the introductory and the operative clauses.

II. Terms

- ***Clause****:* one section of a resolution, containing one argument or one action
- ***Phrase****:* the first word(s) of a clause
- ***Heading****:* the first part of a resolution; this section contains general information
- ***Introductory clauses:*** the second part of a resolution; this section contains the background
- ***Operative clauses:*** the third part of a resolution; this section contains the actions to be taken

III. Formatting

The format of a resolution is strict, and certain rules must therefore be followed:

- The resolution should read as one long sentence – therefore no full stops should be used and there can be no sentences internally.
- Each clause begins with a phrase from the list of introductory phrases or operative phrases (see Annex 1)
- The phrase should be underlined and the first word of the phrase capitalised;
- Introductory phrases are lettered and operative phrases are numbered,
- Each introductory clause ends with a comma and each operative clause ends with a semicolon (the last one ends with a full stop);
- Sub-clauses for introductory clauses are numbered while sub-clauses for operative clauses are lettered;
- All lines of each clause should be indented after the first line;
- Sub-clauses should be further indented;
- Generally the resolution should be single-spaced, but there should be some space between each clause either by skipping a line or increasing the spacing;
- Acronyms and abbreviations should be written out the first time they appear in the resolution. Thereafter they can be abbreviated;
- Spelling should be British standard in English and French standard in French and consistently used within the resolution;
- The resolution should not exceed two pages; the best and most relevant clauses should therefore be selected.

IV. Heading

In the upper right corner, the location and the date (month and year) of the session should be stated.

The title of the resolution should be 'Motion for a Resolution by the Committee on NN'. The draft resolution submitted by a committee becomes a motion in order to be debated and eventually voted upon by the General Assembly. If the motion passes the General Assembly, the wording should change to 'Resolution by the Committee on NN'. The full name of the committee should be indicated without acronym. The title should be centred.

Below the title, the committee theme should be stated. Note that neither the quotation nor the keywords are indicated, but purely the core of the committee theme. Also this should be centred.

The third section includes the names of the committee members and the committee chairperson. It starts by a sentence 'Submitted by:' followed by the names (first name, family name) and the country codes in parenthesis. The country codes used should the ISO two-letter codes (see Annex 1).

V. Introductory clauses

This portion of a resolution identifies and states the problem that needs to be addressed and should highlight past action on the issue.

These clauses deal with the <u>background</u> to the issue e.g.

- Aspects of the current situation
- Current legislation
- Previous attempted solutions
- Reference to organisations active in the field.

The introductory clauses should identify the depth, scope and complexity of a specific problem and highlight possible consequences if a problem is not solved or still persists. It should also make reference to past action in the area (decisions, reports etc.).

The problem should be stated in factual terms and opinions are not expressed in this portion of the resolution. Introductory clauses should be organised in a logical progression and each fact should be listed as a separate clause.

Each clause begins with a present participle (called an introductory phrase) that should be underlined in the text with the first letter capitalised, see Annex 2.

The introductory clauses are always lettered (A, B, C etc.). If a clause requires further explanation, bulleted lists set off by roman numerals (i, ii, iii etc.) can be used.

Each introductory clause ends with a comma (,), including the final one.

VI. Operative clauses

The operative clauses state the actions and/or recommendations that are made to address the problems identified in the introductory clauses. Therefore there should be some connection of problem to a solution. Because resolving most problems involves an exercise of judgment, this is the portion of the resolution where the Committee expresses its opinion.

The operative clauses are <u>proposals</u>, which taken together, would comprise a solution to the problem, a policy response. They should recommend or decide, if competent to do so, on a specific course of action to be taken to solve the problem.

Operative clauses should be organised in a logical progression, with each containing a single idea or proposal. Each operative clause begins with a verb (called an operative phrase) that should be underlined in the text with the first letter capitalised, see Annex 3.

Operative clauses are always numbered (1, 2, 3 etc.). If a clause requires further explanation, bulleted lists set off by letters (a, b, c etc.) can be used.

Each operative clause ends with a semicolon (;), except for the final one which ends with a full-stop (.).

VII. Advice

- Ensure that the resolution is in the proper format.
- Try to cite facts whenever possible and be factually correct.
- Ensure that the resolution 'hangs together' logically.
- Basically, the introductory clauses should justify the action in the operative clauses and the latter should suggest policies and be used to explain what the committee will do to address the issue.

- The introductory clauses have little effect; the arguments for the action proposed and the reasoning behind the calls for action should be in the operative clauses. To gauge the real meaning of a resolution, look at the operative clauses first!

- Write a comprehensive resolution, for example, if your resolution calls for a new programme or body, think about how its tasks and functions.

- At the same time, the resolution should be simple, focused and straight forward. Complex arcanity is not a substitute for quality.

- Long resolutions do not make successful resolutions – being succinct is the key to successful resolution writing. A resolution should not exceed two pages, but often does not need to be longer than a page.

- EYP strongly encourages creativity and recycling old/existing solutions is not the aim of this exercise. Be visionary!

- As stated above, the resolution should be visionary but also kept within the bounds of realistic action; in cases where the EU, for example, cannot act, the resolution can call upon its Member States to act.

- Avoid creating new bodies, agencies, panels and committees to deal with the specific issue. In many cases, in particular in the EU context, there is already such a body existing!

- Remember that the aim is to have a resolution that will promote good debate.

ANNEX 1
Country codes

Albania (AL)
Andorra (AD)
Armenia (AM)
Austria (AT)
Azerbaijan (AZ)
Austria (AT)
Belarus (BY)
Belgium (BE)
Bosnia and Herzegovina (BA)
Bulgaria (BG)
Croatia (HR)
Cyprus (CY)
Czech Republic (CZ)
Denmark (DK)
Estonia (EE)
Finland (FI)
France (FR)
Georgia (GE)
Germany (DE)
Greece (GR)
Hungary (HU)
Iceland (IS)
Ireland (IE)
Italy (IT)
Latvia (LV)
Liechtenstein (LI)
Lithuania (LT)
Luxembourg (LU)
Macedonia, FYR (MK)
Malta (MT)
Moldova (MD)
Monaco (MC)
Montenegro (ME)
Netherlands (NL)
Norway (NO)
Poland (PL)
Portugal (PT)
Romania (RO)
Russia (RU)
San Marino (SM)
Serbia (RS)
Slovakia (SK)
Slovenia (SI)
Spain (ES)
Sweden (SE)
Switzerland (CH)
Turkey (TR)
Ukraine (UA)
United Kingdom (GB)

ANNEX 2
Introductory phrases ● Phrases d'introduction

The introductory clauses of a resolution explain the problem that needs to be solved. Essentially, this section contains everything but proposing action to be taken to solve the problem. Keep in mind that the selection of the introductory phrases will be a first step to determine whether the resolution will be more general or more specific, more radical or softer in its approach.

Introductory phrases are lettered, underlined and separated by commas.

Below are indicated some common introductory phrases, but the list is non-exhaustive.

In English

Acknowledging with (deep) gratitude etc.
Affirming
Alarmed (*by*)
Anxious
Appreciating
Approving
Aware (*of*)
Basing itself
Believing
Bearing in mind
Cognisant
Commending
Concerned (*by*)
Confident
Congratulating
Conscious
Considering
Contemplating
Continuing to take the view
Convinced
Declaring
Deeply alarmed
by/appreciative/concerned/conscious/convinced/disturbed/regretting etc.
Deploring
Desiring
Endorsing
Emphasising
Expecting
Expressing its appreciation/concern/regret/satisfaction/support etc.
Firmly convinced
Fulfilling
Fully alarmed/aware/bearing in mind/believing/deploring/ noting/recalling etc.
Further deploring/recalling etc.
Gravely concerned
Guided (*by*)
Having adopted/approved/considered/considered further/devoted attention/examined/ heard/received/reviewed/studied etc.
Keeping in mind

Noting with (deep)
appreciation/approval/concern/gratitude/regret/satisfaction etc.
Noting further
Observing
Paying tribute
Pointing out
Profoundly concerned
Reaffirming
Realising
Recalling
Reconfirming
Recognising
Referring (*to*)
Regretting
Reiterating its appreciation/conviction/dismay etc.
Reminding
Seeking
Seriously concerned
Stressing
Strongly emphasises/supporting
Supporting (fully)
Taking into account/consideration/note of etc.
Viewing with appreciation
Welcoming

En français

Accueillant avec satisfaction etc.
Affirmant
Agissant
Alarmé (*par*)
Approuvant
Après avoir décidé
Assuré
Attendant avec intérêt
Ayant à l'esprit/adopté/considéré/ entendu/étudié/examiné/pris
connaissance avec satisfaction/reçu etc.
Cherchant
Confiant
Conscient
Considérant
Constatant avec (une vive) préoccupation
Convaincu
Croyant
Déclarant
Démontrant
Déplorant
Désirant
Désireux
Encouragé (*par*)
Espérant
Estimant
Etant (profondément) alarmé (*par*)
Etant tout à fait au courant
Exprimant son accord/sa compréhension/ sa préoccupation/sa satisfaction
etc.
Félicitant
Gardant à l'esprit

Gravement préoccupé
Guidé (*par*)
Insistant (*sur*)
Louant
Notant avec regret/satisfaction etc.
Observant
Pensant
Persuadé
Portant une appréciation positive
Prenant en considération/en compte/note etc.
Préoccupé (*par*)
Profondément préoccupé (*par*)/troublé (*par*) etc.
Rappelant également
Réaffirmant
Réalisant
Reconnaissant
Regrettant (vivement/profondément etc.)
Réitérant
Remarquant avec plaisir/regret etc.
Rendant hommage (*à*)
Renouvelant
Résolu
Sachant
Se déclarant à nouveau préoccupé (par)/de nouveau etc.
Se félicitant
Se réalisant
Se référant
Se souvenant
Soucieux (*de*)
Soulignant (à nouveau/en particulier etc.)
Tenant compte (*de*)
Tout à fait conscient/convaincu etc.

ANNEX 3
Operative phrases ● Phrases d'action

The operative clauses of a resolution describe the actions that need to be taken in order to solve the problem. Operative clauses should be organised in a logical progression, and each clause should contain a single idea or policy proposal. Keep in mind that not all resolutions of the European Parliament are binding. Therefore, it is important to choose the operative phrases and the wording of the operative clauses accordingly.

Operative phrases are, like the introductory phrases, underlined. However, each operative clause begins with a number, ends with a semicolon and the final clause ends with a full stop.

Below are indicated some common operative phrases, but the list is non-exhaustive.

Operative Phrases

Accepts
Affirms
Appeals
Appreciates
Approves
Asks
Authorises
Calls (*for/upon*)
Commends
Concurs
Condemns
Confirms
Congratulates
Considers
Decides
Declares (accordingly)
Deplores
Designates
Directs
Draws attention (*to*)
Emphasises
Encourages
Endorses
Expresses its appreciation/belief/conviction/hope/regret/sympathy/thanks etc.
Further concurs/invites/proclaims/recommends/ reminds/requests/resolves etc.
Has resolved (*to*)
Hopes
Instructs
Invites
Notes (with appreciation/approval/interest/satisfaction etc.)
Proclaims
Proposes
Reaffirms
Recognises
Recommends

Regrets
Reiterates
Reminds
Repeats
Requests
Resolves
Seeks
Solemnly affirms/confirms/declares/condemns/proclaims etc.
Strongly affirms/condemns/urges etc.
Suggests
Supports
Trusts
Takes note (*of*)
Transmits
Trusts
Urges
Welcomes

Phrases d'action

A résolu
Accepte
Accueille avec (une vive) satisfaction/ favorablement etc.
Adjure
Affirme (solennellement)
Appelle
Apprécie
Approuve
Attire l'attention (*sur*)
Autorise
Cherche
Condamne (énergiquement)
Confirme
Considère
Constate (avec préoccupation)
Décide
Déclare d'un commun accord/en conséquence etc.
Demande (de nouveau/instamment etc.)
Déplore (vivement)
Désigne
Encourage
Engage
Espère
Exhorte
Exige
Exprime son appréciation/sa gratitude/sa (sérieuse) préoccupation etc.
Fait appel (*à*)
Fait confiance
Félicite
Incite (*à*)
Insiste (*sur*)
Invite
Lance un appel
Loue
Note
Prend note (avec préoccupation etc.)
Presse

Prie (instamment etc.)
Proclame
Propose
Proroge
Réaffirme
Recommande
Regrette
Rend hommage (*à*)
Remarque
Se déclare convaincu/prêt/satisfait etc.
Se félicite
Soutient
Transmet